AI Daily Brief to Your Telegram

Free chapter from Telegram as Your AI Control Center (Drop Shelf). Tested with n8n 2.x on 2026-09-29.

Every morning at 07:00 this workflow reads your calendar, your unread email and a news feed, asks Claude to turn it into a brief you can read in a minute, and sends it to you on Telegram. Setup takes about 20 minutes. The importable workflow is the JSON file that came with this chapter.

What you need

- n8n 2.x, either n8n Cloud or self-hosted (Docker is fine).
- A Telegram bot of your own. Message @BotFather, send /newbot, and keep the token it gives you.
- Your Telegram chat id. Send any message to your new bot, then open https://api.telegram.org/bot<TOKEN>/getUpdates in a browser and copy message.chat.id.
- An Anthropic API key from console.anthropic.com.
- Google Calendar and Gmail accounts (optional: delete those nodes if you don't use them).

Cost note

Running cost is the API call only. One brief is roughly 2,000 input tokens and 400 output tokens. With claude-opus-5-5 at $4 per million input tokens and $20 per million output tokens, that is about $0.02 per day, or around $0.60 a month. n8n Cloud's starter plan or a $5 VPS covers the hosting.

Step 1: Import the workflow

1. In n8n, open Workflows, then Import from File, and pick ai-daily-brief.workflow.json.
2. You will see eight nodes in a row: Every morning 07:00, Today's calendar, Unread email (24h), Industry news (RSS), Build prompt, Claude: write the brief, Format for Telegram, Send to Telegram.

Step 2: Connect the credentials

1. Today's calendar: create a Google Calendar OAuth2 credential and pick your calendar.
2. Unread email (24h): create a Gmail OAuth2 credential. The search filter skips promotions and social mail.
3. Claude: write the brief: create a Header Auth credential. Name: x-api-key. Value: your Anthropic API key.
4. Send to Telegram: create a Telegram credential with your bot token, then replace YOUR_TELEGRAM_CHAT_ID with your chat id.

Step 3: Test it

1. Click Execute Workflow. Each node turns green as it runs.
2. Open Build prompt to check what the model will see. If a section is empty, the node before it has no data or no credential.
3. Your phone should buzz with the brief within about 20 seconds.

How the Claude call works

The HTTP Request node posts to https://api.anthropic.com/v1/messages with the header anthropic-version: 2023-06-01. The body sets model to claude-opus-5-5, max_tokens to 4000 and output_config.effort to low, which is plenty for summarizing and keeps the call fast and cheap.

It also sends fallbacks: "default" with the header anthropic-beta: server-side-fallback-2026-07-01. If the model ever declines an input (a strange email, for example), the API retries on a fallback model in the same call instead of failing your morning run.

The response is a list of content blocks. Format for Telegram keeps only the text blocks, checks stop_reason for a refusal, and splits long briefs into Telegram-sized messages.

Make it yours

- Change the time: edit triggerAtHour in the first node. The workflow timezone is in Workflow settings.
- Different news: swap the RSS URL, or duplicate the node for more feeds.
- Tone and length: edit the system text inside the Claude node. Ask for bullet points, another language, or a stricter word limit.
- Weekends off: in the trigger, switch to a weekdays-only cron such as 0 7 * * 1-5.

Troubleshooting

- 401 from Claude: the Header Auth name must be exactly x-api-key.
- 400 from Claude: re-import the JSON rather than retyping the body; a stray quote breaks it.
- Telegram "chat not found": you must send your bot a message first, and the chat id is a number.
- Gmail returns nothing: good news, inbox zero. The workflow still runs because the nodes always output data.

What's in the full book

Telegram as Your AI Control Center has 8 to 10 workflows built the same way, each tested and version-stamped, with a cost note: inbox triage with one-tap replies, content drafts you approve or reject from Telegram, invoice extraction to a spreadsheet, lead capture, and more. Updates arrive free through the bot when the tools change.